

GATEWAY Program

The Dispute & Scam Checklist

2. Downloadable Worksheets & Further Reading Hub

A. Worksheet: "The Dispute & Scam Checklist"

- **Purpose:** A digital "cheat sheet" for learners to keep on their phones to use during client negotiations.

5 Red Flags of a Scammer:

e.g. 5 Red Flags of a Scammer:

*The client asks to move the conversation to Telegram or WhatsApp before a contract is started.
The client asks for a "test job" that is actually a full piece of work for free.
The client offers to pay via gift cards or crypto instead of the platform's verified system.
The job description is vague and offers a suspiciously high rate for very little work.
The client has no "Verified Payment" shield and a history of poor ratings from other freelancers.*

The client attempts to migrate communications to external channels like Telegram or WhatsApp prior to contract execution.
The client requests a "test assignment" that constitutes a complete, production-ready deliverable without financial compensation.
The client proposes alternative payment vehicles, such as gift cards or cryptocurrency, bypassing the platform's secure financial infrastructure.
The project scope is poorly defined yet offers a suspiciously inflated rate relative to the minimal effort required.
The client lacks a verified payment method indicator and maintains a history of substandard reviews from previous service providers.

The 3-Step Dispute Protocol:

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*Stop work immediately and keep all further communication strictly on the platform's official chat.
Gather all proof of work (screenshots, drafts, and delivery receipts) as evidence.
Click the "Help" or "Dispute" button to bring in a professional platform mediator to resolve the issue safely.*

Step 1: Stop all work immediately and keep communication within the official platform.

Step 2: Gather all evidence including chats, agreements, submitted work, and timelines.

Step 3: Report through the platform's dispute system and allow formal resolution.



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B. Further Reading Hub (PDF Links/Copy):

- **"The Retainer Revolution"**: A guide on how to price monthly services so you earn a "salary" instead of a "gig fee."
- **"Digital Ethics in the Age of AI"**: A one-page guide on the "Honesty First" approach to using generative AI tools like ChatGPT or Midjourney in professional work.

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